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What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Ford said it expects** to take about \$19.5 billion in charges, mainly tied to its electric-vehicle business, a massive hit as the automaker retrenches in the face of sinking EV demand. **A1**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** fell, with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow industrials retreating 0.2%, 0.6% and 0.1%, respectively. **B9**
- ◆ **Holiday advertisers** got an early start this season, spending more on television spots and digital pitches as they chase inflation-weary shoppers' dollars. **B1**
- ◆ **JPMorgan Chase stepped** further into crypto with its asset-management arm rolling out a tokenized money fund using Ethereum as a record keeper. **B1**
- ◆ **Several states joined** the FTC in suing Uber over deceptive billing and cancellation practices regarding its subscription service. **B2**
- ◆ **Ben & Jerry's plans** to set a term limit for directors in a move that would push three members off its independent board. **B3**
- ◆ **Shares of Juventus** Football Club jumped after Tether offered to buy the soccer team from Italy's Agnelli family, which rejected the bid. **B3**
- ◆ **The family of late Zappos** CEO Tony Hsieh, whose father is administering his \$500 million estate, filed an objection to a purported will that surfaced earlier this year, calling it a "scam." **B3**
- ◆ **China's economic** momentum slowed broadly in November, with a marked weakening in consumer spending, adding pressure on Beijing. **A9**

World-Wide

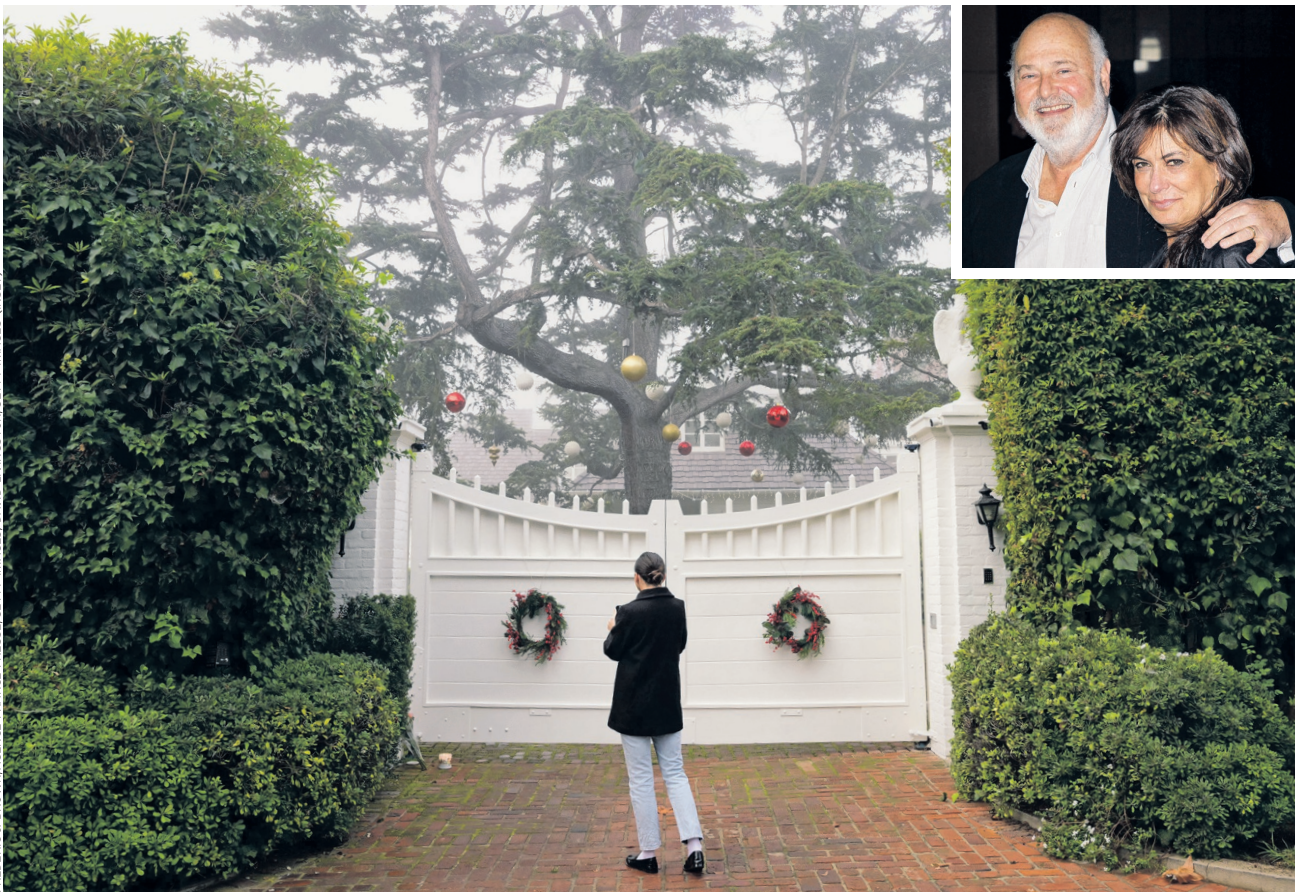
- ◆ **The son of famed** actor-director Rob Reiner and his wife, Michele Singer Reiner, was arrested in Los Angeles on suspicion of the murder of his parents. **A6**
- ◆ **Trump criticized** Rob Reiner on social media after the Democratic activist and donor and his wife were found dead. **A6**
- ◆ **The shooters who** opened fire at a Hanukkah event at Sydney's Bondi Beach appear to have been inspired by Islamic State, Australia's prime minister said. **A1, A8**
- ◆ **The Justice Department** said it arrested four people on charges of plotting a coordinated string of bombings set to go off on New Year's Eve across Southern California. **A4**
- ◆ **European leaders warned** that Russia could attack their countries next amid doubts about Washington's commitment to collective security. **A7**
- ◆ **Ukraine said it used** underwater drones to strike and critically damage a Russian submarine, claiming a first in maritime warfare. **A7**
- ◆ **Trump sued the BBC** for \$10 billion, saying it defamed him in its editing of a documentary featuring his speech before the Capitol riot. **A4**
- ◆ **The Louvre Museum** was closed Monday after staff began a rolling strike to demand better working conditions and improvements to infrastructure, including better security. **A10**
- ◆ **Died: Rob Reiner**, 78, actor-director; **Michele Singer Reiner**, 70, photographer. **A6**
- ... **Arthur L. Carter**, 93, broker and legendary banker. **B1**
- ... **Anthony Geary**, 78, "General Hospital" star. **A4**

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Troubled Son Is Arrested in Reiners' Killing



SHOCK: The Los Angeles home where actor-director Rob Reiner and his wife, Michele Singer Reiner, were slain. Their son Nick, who has battled addiction, was held on suspicion of murder. For video on Rob Reiner's career, scan the code with the articles on **A6**.



'We Were Just Sitting Ducks': How Chaos Unfolded in Sydney

People hid, shielded children as gunmen attacked Hanukkah festivities at beach

SYDNEY—Arsen Ostrovsky's wife and two young daughters were getting ready for the lighting of Hanukkah

By Mike Cherney, Rhiannon Hoyle and Stuart Condie

candles at Sydney's scenic Bondi Beach on Sunday evening when Ostrovsky wandered off to get some food

from a nearby stall. Then, at around 6:40 p.m., shots rang out. Ostrovsky immediately turned back to rush to his family. But "there was such chaos," he said, with bodies falling everywhere in a hail of bullets. He got hit, and went down, too. Wounded, Ostrovsky desperately tried calling his wife to check on her and their two daughters, ages 4 and 8, but was unable to get through. For the next 15 minutes, he was unsure of their fates. The carnage that unfolded at one of Sydney's most iconic locations was unlike anything the country had seen in decades. A

local man, identified by authorities as Ahmed el Ahmed, helped end it when he rushed one of the two assailants and wrestled the man's weapon away. Police shot and killed one shooter. The other suspect was wounded and taken to a hospital under police guard. Officials haven't named the suspects. The attack that left 15 dead stunned a country that has strict firearms regulations and had low gun crime in recent decades. For Australian Jews, it was confirmation of what many believe has been a rising tide of antisemitism since the most recent Israel-Hamas war began,

including a 2024 firebombing of a Melbourne synagogue. Prime Minister Anthony Albanese said it was clear the gunmen were targeting the Jewish event as an act of anti-semitism, and they were inspired by Islamic State. Police said that they found two Islamic State flags and improvised explosive devices in a car registered to the younger of the two suspects. Among those killed were a Holocaust survivor who attended with his children and

◆ **Prime minister says Islamic State inspired shooters...** **A8**

Ford Takes Costly Hit On EVs, Will Shift Lineup

Carmaker expects \$19.5 billion charge, pivots to traditional and hybrid vehicles

By Sharon Terlep

Ford Motor said Monday it expects to take about \$19.5 billion in charges, mainly tied to its electric-vehicle business, a massive hit as the automaker retrenches in the face of sinking EV demand. The sum is among the largest impairments taken by a company and marks the U.S. auto industry's biggest reckoning to date that it can't realize its electric-vehicle ambitions soon. Ford, which has lost \$13 billion on its EV business since 2023, said it would bolster its lineup of gasoline-powered vehicles while shifting to hybrid and so-called extended-range electric vehicles that include onboard gasoline engines. The goal is to pull back from loss-making assets and redeploy capital designated for EVs to models with higher profitability.

"Instead of plowing billions into the future knowing these large EVs will never make money, we are pivoting," Ford Chief Executive Jim Farley said in an interview. "We now know enough about the U.S. market where we have a lot more certainty in this second inning" of reduced-emissions powertrains, he said. Regulatory changes and lackluster demand from American consumers are forcing U.S. automakers to abandon plans to quickly step to an electric-vehicle future. Please turn to page **A4**

◆ **Heard on the Street: Car companies' EV dilemma...** **B9**

Police Hunt for Brown Killer



SEARCH: Federal Bureau of Investigation agents fanned out Monday in Providence, R.I., as police shared new footage of a potential suspect in the mass shooting at Brown University. **A3**

Kohl's Shoppers Chase the Thrill Of Bagging a 15-Cent Sweater

Fans have turned stacking retailer's coupons into a sport; 'that was a total score'

By Suzanne Kapner

Walk through any mall at this time of year and you're bound to hear the typical sounds of the season: Christmas carols. Children crying on Santa's lap. People bragging about their Kohl's Cash. In fairness, it's hard not to feel like you bagged a trophy when you've amassed enough of the coupons to spend a mere 15 cents on a sweater. "I had to dig around in my purse because—who carries change?" said Lisa Sass, a 34-year-old communications

manager in Phoenix. "That was a total score." Kohl's has gotten a lot wrong in the past year—widely panned store changes, declining sales, an ousted CEO. One thing nobody seems to have a problem with is its program for rewarding loyal shoppers. For every \$50 they spend on qualifying purchases, they earn \$10 in Kohl's Cash, which is just as good as real money as long as they use it on specified dates. With few restrictions for redeeming the rewards, die-hard

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Why Everyone Got Trump's Tariffs Wrong

Predictions of the duties' impact on the economy were buoyant or dire. Here's the reality.

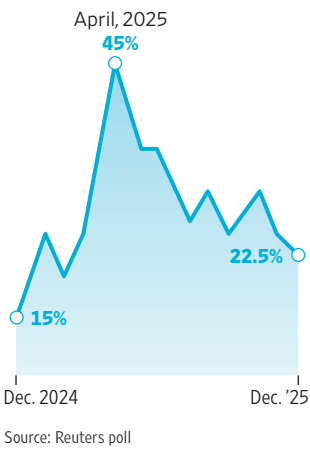
By Chao Deng and Drew An-Pham

When President Trump declared the highest U.S. duties in nearly a century in April, he promised the tariffs would revitalize American manufacturing, bring back middle-class jobs and buoy the economy. Economic experts weren't sold. They forecast peril for the nation's GDP, and expectations of a recession shot up. Both missed the mark. In the days following "Liberation Day," the contrast between Trump's opti-

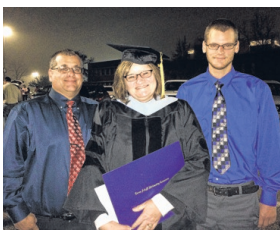
mism and more dire predictions from trade experts and economists was stark. As businesses and consumers tried to make sense of the mixed messages, the president doubled down on promises he'd made during his 2024 presidential campaign. "The markets are going to boom, the stock [market] is going to boom, the country is going to boom," he said on April 3. Economists and business leaders dialed up predictions of a fallout. BlackRock's Larry Fink said "most CEOs I talk

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Odds of a U.S. recession



INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL
Many workers head back to classrooms and trade schools in their 40s. **A12**

JOANNA STERN
Al glasses, pendants and bracelets are put to the test, so you don't waste your money. **A13**

Twin Cities Are Split On Housing Crisis Fix

By Rebecca Picciotto

ST. PAUL and MINNEAPOLIS—Dueling approaches over how to fix America's housing crisis are splitting Minnesota's Twin Cities. In 2022, St. Paul enacted one of the strictest rent-control regimes in the country. The ordinance capped annual rent increases at 3% for most apartments, even empty ones. It didn't adjust for inflation. Across the Mississippi River, Minneapolis steered clear of rent control. Instead, city officials strictly focused on creating new housing. A package of land-use revisions in 2020

made it easier to build apartments, in part by removing restrictions that limited housing to single-family homes. Now, the results are coming into focus. Permits to build apartments in St. Paul plummeted by 79% in early 2022 from the year before, according to data from the Department of Housing and Urban Development. Real-estate investment activity nearly froze. Developers halted new projects as lenders pulled back. Property values declined as investment cooled. All this compounded the existing real-estate problems brought on by

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